INDIAN LAW & DEALMAKING · 15 OCTOBER 2026

Five moves shaping the board now.

- Supreme Court enforces strict 30-day IBC limitation
- SEBI confirms interim ban on Rajesh Exports
- Noel Tata files caveat against Venu Srinivasan
- CCEA approves Fairfax for IDBI Bank stake
- ED attaches 129.85 crore in TTD scam

SWIPE →

INSOLVENCY · SUPREME COURT

Limitation for IBC appeals starts from order pronouncement date

On October 14, 2026, the Supreme Court held that the statutory 30-day limitation period under Section 62 of the IBC strictly runs from the pronouncement of the NCLAT order rather than receipt of a certified copy. The Assistant Commissioner of Central Tax brought the appeal against Sreenivasa Rao Ravinuthala, which the Apex Court dismissed as time-barred.

THE READ

Litigants can no longer rely on administrative delays in obtaining certified copies to extend appellate timelines under the IBC. Tax authorities and creditors must initiate immediate filings upon oral pronouncement to preserve statutory remedies.

SECURITIES · SEBI ENFORCEMENT

SEBI sustains interim market ban on Rajesh Exports promoter

On October 14, 2026, SEBI issued a confirmatory order maintaining an ex-parte trading ban against Rajesh Exports Limited and its promoter Rajesh Mehta. The regulator's action follows an inquiry into alleged balance sheet misrepresentations of 15,000 crore and unrecorded related-party transfers.

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The order underscores SEBI's stance on enforcing market entry bans early in financial misstatement investigations. Boards facing regulatory scrutiny must anticipate immediate operational restrictions prior to full adjudication.

GOVERNANCE · BOMBAY HIGH COURT

Noel Tata files caveat in Tata trust governance rift

On October 14, 2026, Noel N. Tata filed a preemptive caveat in the Bombay High Court against fellow trustee Venu Srinivasan and three others. The filing aims to prevent ex-parte orders regarding the internal governance and board decisions of the Sir Dorabji Tata Trust.

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Caveat strategy highlights defensive posture among corporate leaders anticipating ex-parte relief applications in court. Strategic stakeholders should ensure procedural mechanisms are activated ahead of contested governance disputes.

M&A · CCEA / FINANCE MINISTRY

CCEA clears Fairfax acquisition of controlling IDBI Bank stake

On October 14, 2026, the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs approved Prem Watsa's Fairfax Financial Holdings to acquire a 60.72 percent stake in IDBI Bank for 52,878.08 crore. The transaction transfers government and Life Insurance Corporation equity to the strategic acquirer.

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The clearance represents a landmark step forward in India's long-delayed bank privatization program. Dealmakers should expect increased regulatory alignment for large-scale foreign entry into financial institutions.

ENFORCEMENT · PMLA ADJUDICATION

ED attaches properties in Tirumala Tirupati ghee scam

On October 14, 2026, the Enforcement Directorate provisionally attached real estate and bank assets worth 129.85 crore in connection with the TTD adulterated ghee investigation. Issued against Premier Agri Foods and related entities, the order brings total asset seizures in the probe to 132.55 crore.

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The attachment illustrates the ED's aggressive push to seize commercial assets early in public procurement scams. Corporate suppliers in state procurement face immediate freeze risks upon allegations of supply chain fraud.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Across forum rulings and regulatory interventions, Indian legal forums are enforcing unwavering procedural timelines and regulatory accountability. Statutory deadlines under insolvency law remain unyielding to administrative requests, while regulators maintain market access restrictions on questionable balance sheets. In parallel, executive clearances for major banking transactions show a continued push for strategic privatization alongside strict asset enforcement in public supply disputes.

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